HUMAN RESOURCES · SEPARATION DOCUMENTATION

Exit Interview Record

Naveera · Coach, Field & School Support · Interviewed by **Tahir Saleem** · 25 August 2026

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TENURE	LAST WORKING DAY	SEPARATION TYPE	TERMS
2.5 Years	31st (Mon)	Voluntary	Amicable

1 Employee Details

Employee Name	Naveera
Designation	Coach — Field & School Support
Length of Service	Approximately 2.5 years
Last Working Day	31st (Monday)
Interview Date & Mode	25 August 2026 — in-person exit conversation
Type of Separation	Voluntary resignation, on amicable terms
Rehire Recommendation	Yes — no performance or conduct concerns on either side

2 Reasons for Leaving

Three separate drivers, recorded in the order of importance she gave them — the decision to leave pre-dated the opportunity that made it possible.

DRIVER	DETAIL
1. Discomfort with the programme direction ORIGINAL TRIGGER	She had already intended to resign because she was not at peace with the phase the work was moving into — specifically the growing technology load on teachers. This pre-dated her PhD admission.
2. PhD admission PRACTICAL DRIVER	Admission secured to a programme starting **early January**. She intends to spend the intervening **four months** at home in Lahore. This set the timing of her exit.
3. Fatigue PREVIOUSLY FLAGGED	She reported being significantly tired and noted she had raised this earlier as well. She had also undergone surgery and taken medical leave during her tenure.

POINT TO NOTE FOR HR

This is not simply a "leaving to study" case. Dissatisfaction with the field technology rollout was an **existing and independent factor**, and the fatigue had been flagged before without resolution. Recording the exit as PhD-driven alone would obscure a genuine retention signal.

3 What Worked — Strengths

- **Teamwork and atmosphere.** A genuinely strong teamwork culture at the hub. Her biggest personal learning was **collaboration and how to support others**.

- **Technology team.** "A big support, always." Her concerns were about product decisions, **not** the people delivering them.
- **Manager and colleagues.** Support was consistently available; colleagues stepped in whenever a field issue arose.
- **Cover during medical leave.** Coaches took on her workload voluntarily during her surgery and recovery. Nothing was left unfinished — her strongest example of the culture.
- **Trainings and summer workstreams.** Every member delivered their share without needing follow-up.

> **STRENGTH TO PROTECT**
> Peer support and voluntary workload cover are a demonstrated strength. They should be formally recognised rather than assumed.

4 Issues Formally Flagged

4.1 Professionalism and professional ethics PRIMARY FLAG

Her strongest concern, raised twice — at organisational level and again when asked specifically about HR and the RM cadre.

- **Workplace language.** An overall shortfall in professionalism, particularly in the language used in the office. She was clear that her concern is *not* ordinary humour, but remarks that go "over the line" — and that a number of people do this.
- **No defined boundary** on what is and is not appropriate to discuss during office hours.
- **RMs discussing coaches with other coaches.** Her most specific concern. She repeatedly heard information not meant for her — about another sector or another coach — shared with her directly by an RM. RM-to-RM discussion is understandable; an RM discussing a coach with a **different, subordinate coach is unprofessional**. The impact: it creates a pre-formed impression of that coach, and because the practice is widespread, "everyone ends up knowing something about everyone." She described the damage as unpredictable. Many coaches are also personal friends, so information received in one capacity distorts the relationship in another. She had **already raised this with Bilal** — this is not the first report.

> **ACTION SHE REQUESTED**
> A deliberate effort on professional ethics and communication boundaries, involving **everyone including leadership and the RM cadre** — not coaches alone.

4.2 Technology is burdening teachers rather than supporting them

She named the tools specifically: the **chatbot**, **AI-based transcription** and the **digital lesson plans**. In her own assessment these are adding to teachers' burden instead of facilitating their work.

- She sees teachers visibly upset and distressed, **particularly those receiving feedback on lesson-plan quality** — so the concern is how quality judgements reach teachers, not the tools' existence.
- In fairness, she accepted that some of this may **streamline over time**; her objection is to the present experience on the ground.
- This is what produced her sense of being "in the wrong place, specifically with regard to teachers and students."

> **WHY THIS MATTERS MOST**
> This is a **mission-alignment concern**, not a product complaint. A coach with 2.5 years in the field is reporting that what we build is distressing the people the organisation exists to serve. Of everything raised, this carries the greatest risk.

4.3 The escalation route feels closed

- She raised these concerns in multiple forums and directly with her RM, and described herself as someone who speaks up consistently.
- The response she received was that these matters are **not within the field team's control** — decisions come from leadership, and the field can raise concerns but nothing more.
- Her conclusion after 2.5 years: anything originating from the leadership mindset has to be implemented regardless of whether it benefits the field.

> **ACTION SHE REQUESTED**
> A credible feedback loop where field concerns visibly influence decisions instead of being acknowledged and closed. Her position amounts to learned helplessness — someone who spoke up for 2.5 years concluded that speaking up changed nothing.

4.4 Product testing is not conducted in representative schools

Her most concrete and most implementable recommendation.

- She credited the organisation for **having** sent staff into the field to test. But from what she has heard, testing has largely been in schools that are **nearby, better resourced and urban**.
- Conditions differ sharply where coaches actually work — the **villages around Tarnol**, where conditions are very poor, and the **hilly, remote settlements with no internet facility at all**.
- **Her recommendation:** the teams building these tools should themselves visit the distant, low-resource schools, so they get a **reality check** and can design in a more grounded way. She did not ask for the tools to be withdrawn — she asked for the **builders to be put on the ground**.

5 Function-by-Function Feedback

FUNCTION	STATUS	DETAIL
Team & colleagues	POSITIVE	Strong support and collaboration throughout.
Technology team	POSITIVE	Consistently supportive; no concerns about the team itself.
Reporting Manager (RM)	FLAG	Supportive overall. Flagged: professional ethics — RMs should not discuss one coach with another coach.
Human Resources	FLAG	No operational complaints. Flagged: professional ethics and workplace language.
Admin	RESOLVED	No issues. The faulty **switch** was raised and has since been repaired (attended to at 9 pm).
IT	CLEAR	No issues beyond the switch, now resolved.
Operations & Logistics	CLEAR	No issues at all, including the operations lead — "everything with you people has been very good."
Hub location & commute	RESOLVED	Explicitly described as a **personal** difficulty, not an organisational failing — her home was far from the hub. Resolved through pick-up arrangements. She noted Hamza travels longer as he is collected first, but treated this as a matter between friends, and confirmed she received **good support**.

6 Recommended Action Items

#	ACTION	OWNER	PRIORITY	REF
1	Run a structured intervention on **professional ethics, workplace language and communication boundaries** — covering the RM cadre and leadership, not coaches alone.	Human Resources	HIGH	4.1
2	Issue written guidance that **an RM must not discuss a coach's performance or issues with other coaches or subordinates**, with the reasoning explained.	HR + RM Leads	HIGH	4.1
3	Require product and technology teams to conduct **field testing in remote, low-resource and low- or no-connectivity schools** — e.g. the Tarnol-area villages and hilly settlements — not only nearby urban schools.	Product / Tech Leadership	HIGH	4.4
4	Review the **workload the current tools place on teachers** and measure that burden *before* further tooling is introduced. Review how lesson-plan quality feedback is delivered.	Programme / Product	HIGH	4.2
5	Establish a visible **field-to-leadership feedback loop** so escalated concerns receive a documented response.	Leadership	MEDIUM	4.3
6	Formally **recognise the peer-support culture** as a retention strength worth protecting.	Human Resources	MEDIUM	3

> **CAUTION ON ITEM 1**
> If this becomes professional-conduct training for coaches only, it inverts her point. She was explicit that leadership and the RM cadre must be included.

7 Overall Assessment

The separation is **voluntary and amicable**, with no performance or conduct concerns on either side; a rehire recommendation is appropriate. The exit is driven principally by a confirmed **PhD admission in January** and a need for rest — but dissatisfaction with the direction of the field technology rollout was an existing and independent factor, and should not be recorded as a study-related departure alone.

Her feedback carries weight because it is specific. She distinguishes clearly between what worked — people, collaboration, peer support, admin and operations — and what did not: professional boundaries, the burden the current tools place on teachers, and product testing that is not representative of the schools coaches actually serve. **Action items 1 to 4 are the substantive takeaways.** The interview closed with thanks for her service and best wishes for her doctoral studies.

8 Appendix — Verbatim Quotes

> **ON HER REASON FOR LEAVING**
> *"Mujhe barre arse se ek guilt si feeling honay lag gayi thi ke maybe I am in the wrong place — specifically with regard to teachers and students."*
> For a long time I had begun to feel a sense of guilt — that perhaps I am in the wrong place, specifically with regard to teachers and students.

ON RM CONDUCT — THE PRIMARY FLAG

"Ek RM jab ek coach se discuss kar raha ho, aur apne subordinate se kisi aur coach ke hawale se baat kar raha ho, to woh bohat unprofessional si baat ho jati hai."

When an RM is discussing matters with a coach, and is talking to his own subordinate about some other coach, that becomes a very unprofessional thing.

ON TECHNOLOGY AND TEACHERS

"Woh lesson plans aur abhi jo is time par idea hai — technology — woh teachers ko burden bohat zyada kar raha hai, facilitate karne ki bajaye. Main teachers ko bohat upset, bohat pareshan dekhti hoon."

Those lesson plans, and the current idea of technology, are burdening teachers a great deal rather than facilitating them. I see teachers who are very upset and very distressed.

ON ESCALATION

"Jo cheez leadership ke mindset se aayegi, humein implement karni hi karni hai — chahay humein us se jitna marzi faida ho."

Whatever comes from the leadership mindset, we simply have to implement it — regardless of how much benefit it actually brings us.

ON FIELD TESTING — HER KEY RECOMMENDATION

"Jo team yeh cheezain bana rahi hai, woh un schools mein bhi jaye jo bohat door hain, jahan proper resources nahi hain, jahan actual masail hain — taake un ko ek reality check mil sake aur woh zyada grounded ho ke cheezain bana sakein."

The team that is building these things should also go to the schools that are far away, where there are no proper resources, where the real problems are — so that they get a reality check and can build things in a more grounded way.

Tahir Saleem

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